

FileBandit

Your Android file manager, with fast transfer to iPhone and computers

Version 3.0

Part 1 · Features – what the app can do.

Part 2 · How-To – step-by-step guides for everything, plus fixes for common problems.

Needs Android 11 or newer. The other device only needs a web browser.

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Part 1 · Features

FileBandit started as a fast way to move files between an Android phone and an iPhone. Version 3.0 makes it a complete file manager as well, with the transfer built in as one of its features.

At a glance

Manage every file

Browse internal storage and SD cards. Copy, move, rename, share. Recents, favorites, search, sort, grid view.

Safe by default

Deleting goes to a recycle bin for 30 days, and every action offers Undo.

Open things inside the app

Photo gallery, video and audio player, PDF reader, text editor.

Archives

Create zip files. Extract zip, 7z, rar, tar, gz, bz2 and xz.

Clean up

Find the biggest files, true duplicates and leftover junk, then clear them safely.

Apps

Back up an app's APK, share it, open its settings or uninstall it.

Private vault

Encrypted storage opened with your PIN and optional fingerprint.

Network locations

Browse a NAS, PC or server over SFTP, SMB, FTP or WebDAV.

Transfer to iPhone and computers

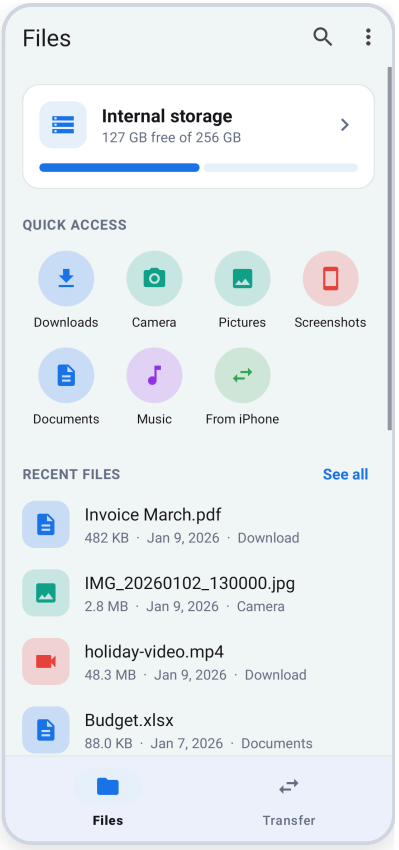
Scan a code and move files over Wi-Fi in either direction. Nothing to install on the other device. Uploads resume if the connection drops, the link can ask for a PIN, and every transfer is kept in a history.

The app has two tabs

Files is the file manager (with the tools Storage, Vault, Apps and Network). **Transfer** connects to an iPhone or computer.

1 Files, recents and favorites

- The home screen shows quick-access folders (Downloads, Camera, Pictures, Screenshots, Documents, Music, Movies and the folder that receives files from your iPhone), your **favorites**, your **recent files**, and categories such as Images, Videos, Audio, Documents, Apps and Archives.
- Internal storage and every SD card or USB drive are listed with how full they are.
- Press and hold anything to start selecting. Then copy, move, delete, share, rename, view details or send it.
- **Search** looks inside subfolders too. Sort by name, date, size or type, and show hidden files if you want them.
- Use **Add to favorites** (or ⋮ → **Add folder to favorites** inside a folder) for one-tap access from the home screen.

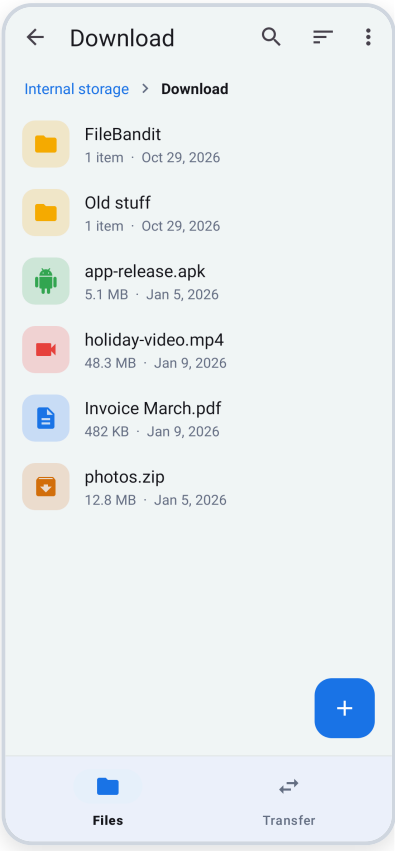


Files home

2 Recycle bin and Undo

- Deleting moves items to the **Trash**. They stay for **30 days**, then go for good.
- Right after deleting, copying, moving or renaming, a bar at the bottom offers **Undo**.
- In the Trash you can **Restore** items to where they were, **Delete forever**, or **Empty trash**. (Deleting a file straight from a folder with ⋮ → **Delete permanently** skips the bin.)

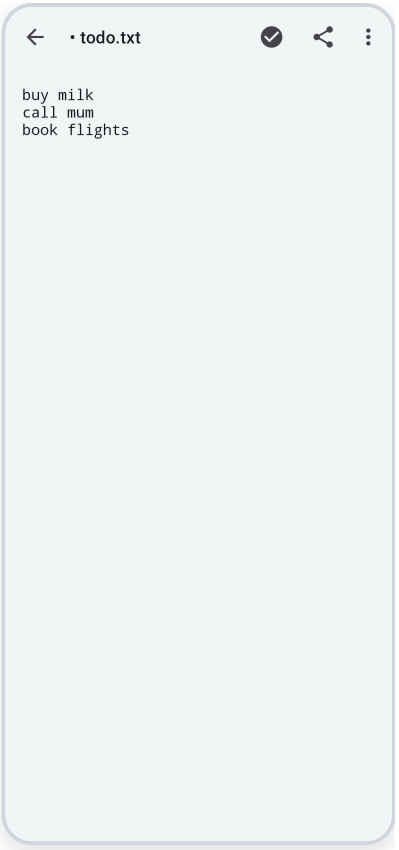
Network servers have no bin. Deleting there is immediate, and the app says so before it does it.



Undo after deleting

3 Viewers and editor

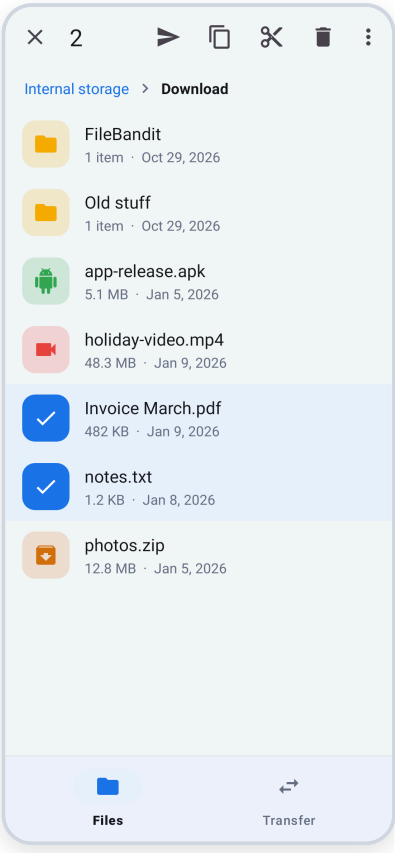
- **Photos:** swipe between pictures, pinch or double-tap to zoom. Animated GIFs play.
- **Video and audio:** built-in player with play, pause and a seek bar.
- **PDF:** scroll through pages and zoom.
- **Text and code:** read, edit and **Save**.
- Anything the app can't show opens in another app you choose ("Open with another app").



Text viewer and editor

4 Compress and extract

- Select files or folders and choose **Compress to zip**. Pick the name.
- Select an archive and choose **Extract here**. It creates a folder next to the archive. Works with **zip, 7z, rar, tar, tar.gz, tar.bz2, tar.xz** and **gz**.
- Extraction refuses archives that try to write outside their folder, so a booby-trapped file can't overwrite things.



Compress dialog

5 Batch rename and grid view

- Select several files and choose **Rename…** to rename them all at once: **Number them** (Holiday_001…), **Find and replace**, **Add before / after**, **Change capitals**, or **Use the date**.
- A live preview shows each new name before you confirm, and warns about clashes.
- **Grid view** shows big thumbnails, ideal for photos and videos. Switch from the ⋮ menu.
- Selection tools: Select all, Invert selection, Select by type….



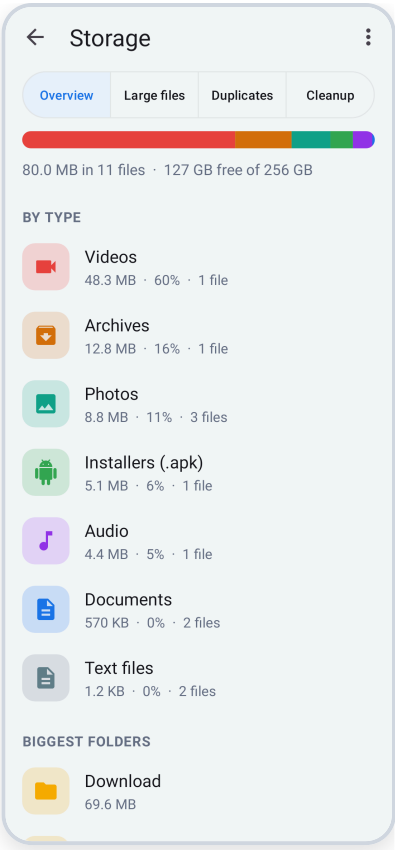
Grid view

6 Storage cleaner

Open **Storage** from the Files home. Four tabs:

- **Overview** – how much space each type of file and each big folder uses.
- **Large files** – the biggest files first.
- **Duplicates** – files with identical *content* (not just the same name). The app keeps the oldest copy and selects the extras for you.
- **Cleanup** – caches, thumbnails, old installers and half-finished downloads.

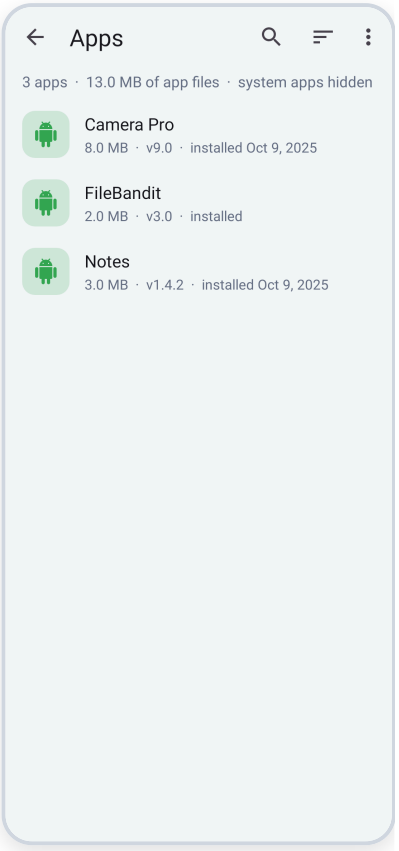
Cleaning moves things to the recycle bin (caches are removed for good) so a mistake can be undone.



Storage overview

7 Apps manager

- Lists every installed app with its size and install or update date. Search and sort. System apps are hidden unless you ask.
- **Back up APK** saves the app's installer to `FileBandit/Apps`. **Share APK** sends it to someone else.
- Tap an app for **App info** (Android's own settings page) or **Uninstall**.

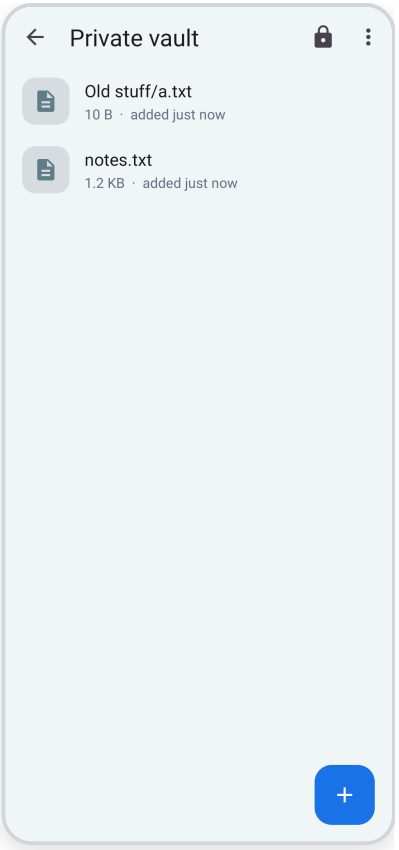


Installed apps

8 Private vault

- Files you put in the vault are **encrypted** (AES-256). Other apps and anyone borrowing your phone can't read them.
- You unlock with a **PIN** (4 or more characters, letters allowed) and, if you like, your **fingerprint**. The encryption key is also tied to this phone's secure hardware, so a copied vault folder is useless elsewhere.
- It **locks itself** 30 seconds after you leave the app. Five wrong PINs in a row make it wait 30 seconds, then longer.
- The vault screen is hidden from screenshots and the recent-apps view.
- Move files in from the Files tab ("Move to private vault...") or add them with the + button. Take them out again whenever you like.

> **There is no "forgot PIN".** If you forget it, nobody, including us, can recover the files. Pick something you'll remember.



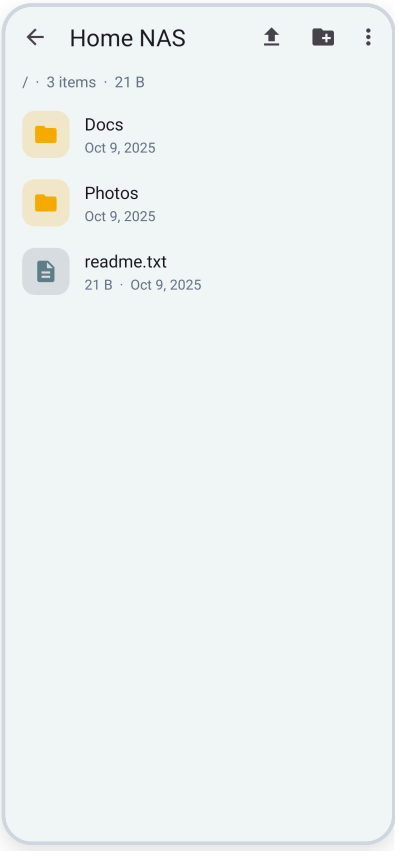
Inside the vault

9 Network locations

Browse a server like a folder on your phone: open files, download, upload, rename, delete, make folders.

Type	Use it for
SFTP	Linux machines, Macs with Remote Login, many NAS boxes. Password or private key. The server's identity is remembered the first time and checked after that.
SMB	Windows shared folders, Macs with File Sharing, most NAS boxes.
FTP / FTPS	Routers with a USB disk, older NAS boxes, web hosting. FTPS adds encryption.
WebDAV	Nextcloud, ownCloud and many NAS boxes (http or https).

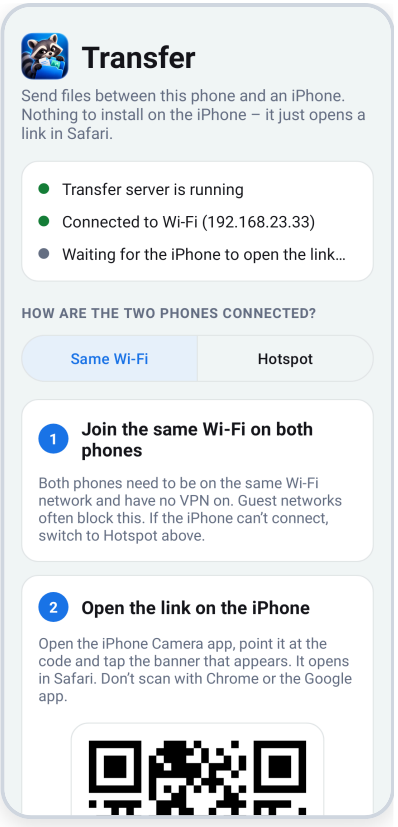
Saved passwords are encrypted with a key kept in the phone's secure hardware.



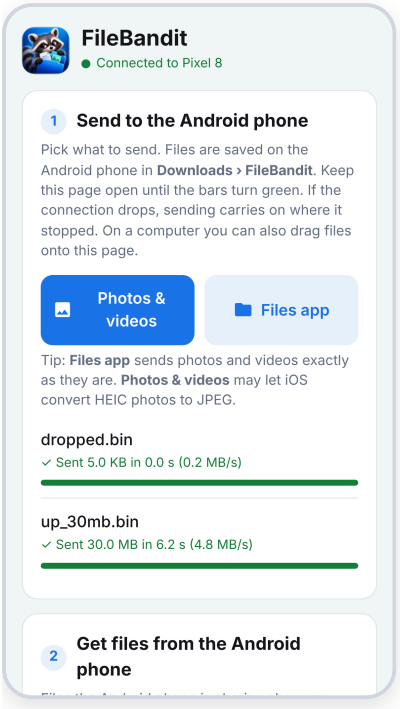
Browsing a server

10 Transfer to iPhone and computers

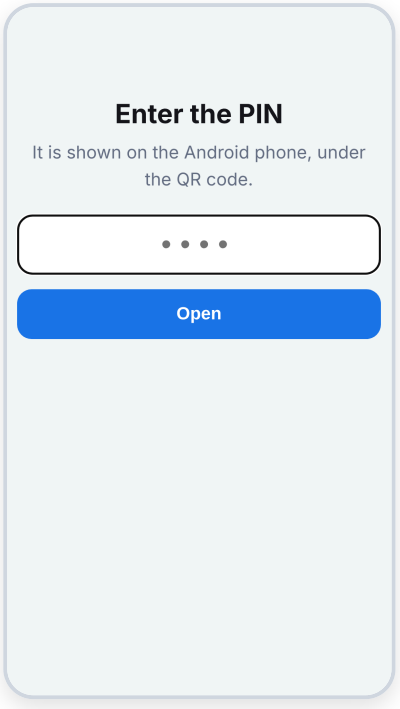
- The phone runs a small, fast web server. The other device opens a link in its browser, so **nothing needs installing on it**.
- Connect over the **same Wi-Fi** or with the phone's own **Hotspot** mode (no router needed).
- A **QR code** opens the page straight from the iPhone camera. On a computer, use **Copy link** or **Share link**.
- Both directions: send files from Android (folders go as a zip, or use **Download all**), and receive photos, videos and files from the other device into `Downloads/FileBandit`.
- **Resumable:** big uploads go up in pieces; if Wi-Fi blips or the screen locks, sending carries on where it stopped.
- **PIN on the link:** switch on "Ask for a PIN" and the page asks for a 4-digit PIN first.
- **History** of everything sent and received, kept even after restarting the app.
- On a computer you can **drag and drop** files onto the page.
- Built-in **self test** and a troubleshooting checklist for when something won't connect.



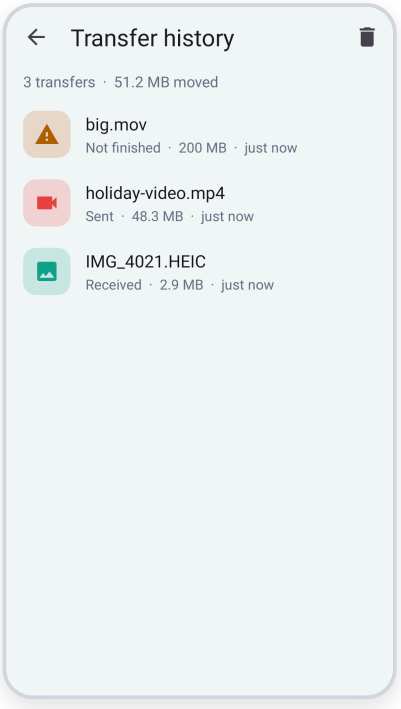
Transfer tab: status, steps and QR code



What the iPhone or computer sees



PIN page (when switched on)



Transfer history

Part 2 · How-To

A · Install and first start

1. On your Android phone open **github.com/bparkstx/fastshare/releases/tag/latest** and tap **FileBandit.apk**.
2. Open the downloaded file. If Android asks, allow **Install unknown apps** for your browser, then go back and tap **Install**.
3. Open FileBandit. The first time, it asks for **All files access**. Tap the button, switch FileBandit on in the Android screen that appears, and press Back. This is what lets it show and manage every file, like any file manager.

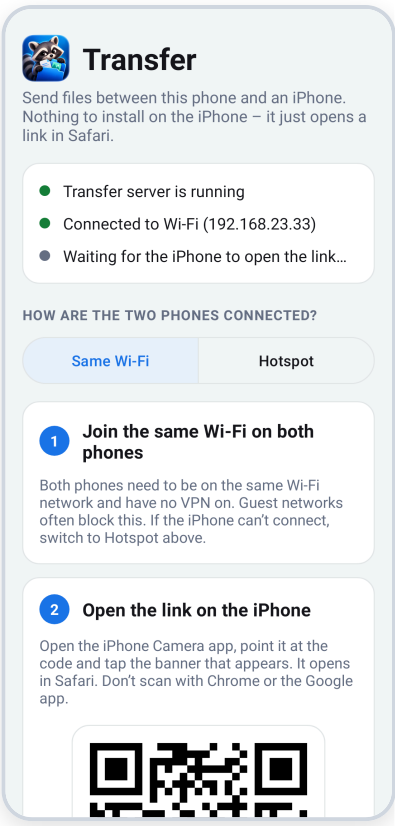
> Already have the older FastShare? Just install over it. Your settings stay and it becomes FileBandit.

B · Everyday file tasks

I want to…	Do this
Open a folder or file	Tap it. Pictures, videos, audio, PDFs and text open inside the app.
Select files	Press and hold one, then tap others. The top bar shows how many. ⋮ has **Select all**, **Invert selection** and **Select by type…**.
Copy or move	Select → tap **Copy** or **Move** (in the top bar or its ⋮ menu) → open the destination folder → tap **Paste here** in the bar at the bottom.
Delete	Select → tap the bin icon. Tap **Undo** straight away if it was a mistake. To get something back later: Files home → **Trash** → select → **Restore**.
Delete for good	Select → ⋮ → **Delete permanently**, and confirm.
Rename one or many	Select → ⋮ → **Rename…**. With several files you get the batch options and a live preview.
Make a zip	Select → ⋮ → **Compress to zip** → name it.
Open an archive	Select it → ⋮ → **Extract here**. A new folder appears next to it.
Find something	Tap the magnifier at the top. It searches the current folder and the folders inside it.
Pin a folder	Open it and tap ⋮ → **Add folder to favorites**, or select it → ⋮ → **Add to favorites**. It shows on the home screen.
Change how it looks	⋮ → **Grid view**, **Sort by** or **Show hidden files**.

C · Send files to an iPhone or computer

1. On the Android phone open the **Transfer** tab. The three dots at the top show if the server is running, if the phone is on Wi-Fi, and if the other device has connected.
2. **Connect the two devices.** Choose **Same Wi-Fi** and make sure both are on the same network with no VPN. No shared Wi-Fi? Choose **Hotspot**, tap **Start hotspot**, then on the iPhone scan the QR code under **1. Join hotspot** with the Camera and tap Join. Then switch the tab to **2. Open page** for the next step.
3. **Open the link.** On an iPhone open the **Camera** app, point it at the QR code and tap the banner. It opens in **Safari**. On a computer, tap **Copy link** or **Share link** on the phone and paste it into a browser.
4. **Choose what to send.** Either, in the Files tab, press and hold the files and tap the **send arrow**, or in the Transfer tab use **Send to the iPhone → My files / Photos**. You can also use **Share → FileBandit** in any other app.
5. On the other device the files appear under **"Get files from the Android phone"**. Tap **Download** (and **Download** again in the Safari prompt). For several items tap **Download all** to get one zip. On iPhone, find them in the Files app under Downloads.



Files ready to send

> **Photos into the iPhone's Photos app:** next to a picture or video tap **Save to Photos**, then **Tap to save**.

D · Receive files from an iPhone or computer

1. Connect and open the link as in steps 1–3 above.
2. On the page, under **"Send to the Android phone"**, tap **Photos & videos** or **Files app** (on a computer you can also **drag files onto the page**). Choose the files.
3. Keep the page open until each bar turns green. If the connection drops, it reconnects and **carries on where it stopped**.
4. On the Android phone tap **Open received files**. Files are in `Downloads/FileBandit`. The **History** button in the Transfers card lists everything that was moved.

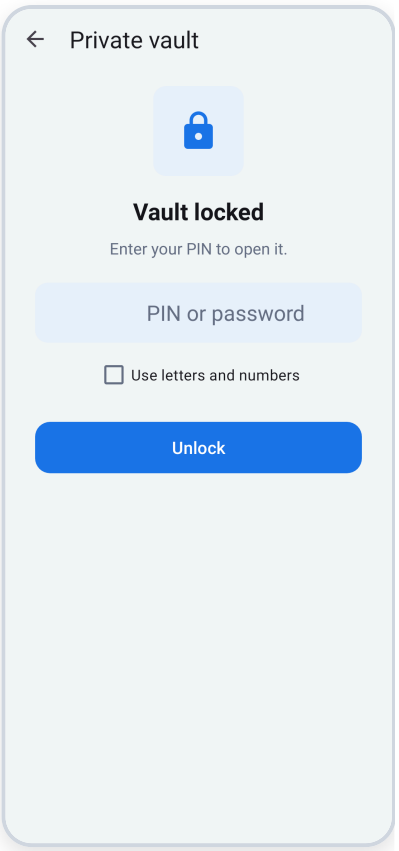
> **Best quality: Files app** sends photos and videos exactly as they are. **Photos & videos** may let iOS convert HEIC photos to JPEG or shrink videos.

Protect the link with a PIN

In the Transfer tab, under the QR code, switch on **Ask for a PIN**. A 4-digit number appears. The other device must enter it before it sees anything. Tap the number to get a new one (everyone has to enter it again). Five wrong tries lock that device out for 30 seconds, then longer.

E · Use the vault

1. Files home → **Vault**. The first time, choose a PIN (4 or more characters; tick **Use letters and numbers** for a password) and type it twice. Remember it: there is no recovery.
2. **Put files in:** either select files in the Files tab → ⋮ → **Move to private vault…** (they are encrypted and the originals deleted after a check that the copy is complete), or in the vault tap **+** and pick files (the originals stay where they were, so delete them yourself if you want them gone).
3. **Open a file:** tap it. Pictures, text, PDFs and media open in the app's secure viewer. A temporary decrypted copy is wiped when you lock the vault.
4. **Take files out:** press and hold → tap the download arrow. They go to `Documents/FileBandit Restored`. The bin icon deletes them for good.
5. **Turn on fingerprint:** ⋮ → **Turn on fingerprint unlock**. Your PIN still works as a backup. **Change PIN** and **Lock now** are in the same menu.

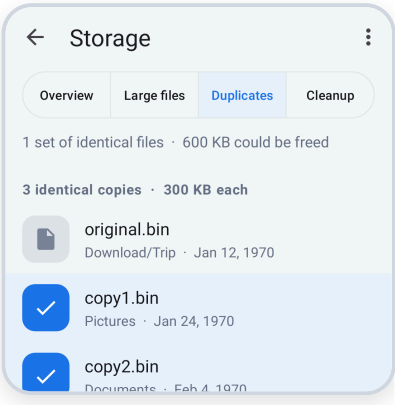


Locked vault

F · Free up space

1. Files home → **Storage**. Wait for the scan to finish.
2. **Large files:** look at the top of the list. Select what you don't need and tap the delete button at the bottom.
3. **Duplicates:** open the tab, then ⋮ → **Select extra copies**. The oldest copy of each set is kept. Check the total shown at the bottom, then delete.
4. **Cleanup:** ⋮ → **Select all** → delete. Caches are removed; installers and partial downloads go to the Trash first.

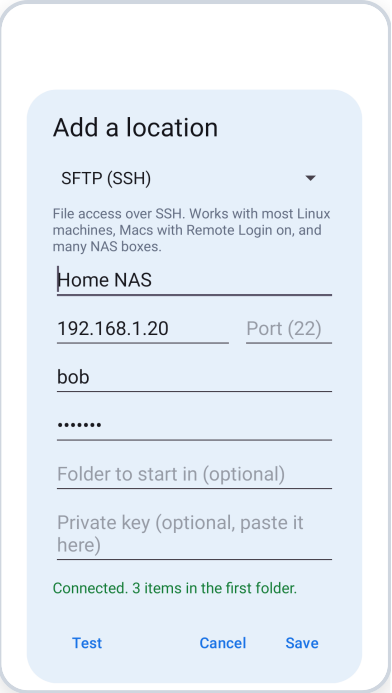
> Anything you remove goes to the **Trash** for 30 days (except caches), so you can change your mind. The Trash itself takes up space until it is emptied.



Duplicates

G · Connect to a NAS or server

1. Files home → **Network** → tap **+**.
2. Pick the **type** (a short explanation appears under it). Fill in a **name**, the **address** (like `192.168.1.20` or `nas.local`), your **user name** and **password**. Leave the port empty to use the usual one.
3. For **SMB** type the **shared folder's name** (as shown on the computer). For others you can type a folder to start in.
4. Tap **Test**. A green message means it worked; otherwise it says what's wrong in plain words. Then tap **Save**.
5. Tap the location to browse. Tap a folder to go in, **Back** to go up. Tap a file to open it.



Adding and testing a location

Task	How
Download	Press and hold → tap the download arrow. Saved in `Downloads/FileBandit/<location name>`.
Upload from the picker	In the server folder tap the **upload arrow** at the top and choose files.
Upload from the Files tab	Select files → ⋮ → **Upload to network location…** → choose the server → open the target folder → tap **Upload here**.
New folder / rename / delete	Folder-plus icon at the top; or select an item and use **Rename** / the bin icon. Deleting on a server is immediate.
Edit or remove a location	On the Network list, press and hold it.

SFTP: if you use a key instead of a password, paste the private key into the box that appears (the password field then unlocks the key). The first connection remembers the server's identity. If that ever changes, the app refuses and warns you.
Secure types with a home-made certificate: tick **Trust this server's certificate**.
Plain FTP and WebDAV over http send the password unencrypted, so use them only on a network you trust.

Google Drive, Dropbox and OneDrive are **not** included. Their developer programs require the app's publisher to register the app first. Nextcloud and most home servers work through WebDAV or SFTP.

H · Troubleshooting

The iPhone shows "ERR_CONNECTION_TIMED_OUT" or never loads

- Open the link with the **Camera** app and **Safari**. In Chrome or other browsers on iPhone, turn on **Settings → that browser → Local Network**.
- The iPhone must be on **Wi-Fi**, not mobile data, and on the **same network** as the Android phone.
- Turn off any **VPN** on both devices.
- Guest Wi-Fi and some routers ("AP isolation") stop devices seeing each other. Switch to **Hotspot** mode, which needs no router.
- If the phone shows more than one address, tap **Other address** and scan again.
- Tap **Test this phone's server** (in "iPhone can't connect? Try these") to find out whether the problem is the app or the network.

Transfers are slow or keep stopping

- 5 GHz Wi-Fi is much faster than 2.4 GHz. On the iPhone, switch off **Low Data Mode** for the network.
- Keep both screens on and stay on the page while files move. The page asks the iPhone to stay awake, and a dropped connection resumes by itself.
- Speed depends on the Wi-Fi link. There is no compression or encryption overhead.

Other problems

Problem	Fix
The app says it needs file access	Files tab → grant **All files access**, then come back.
Can't open a file inside the vault	The vault can show pictures, text, PDFs and media. For other types, take the file out first.
Fingerprint button is missing	The phone has no fingerprint set up, or the vault isn't unlocked yet. Unlock with the PIN, then use ⋮ → Turn on fingerprint unlock.
"Can't reach …" for a server	Check it is switched on, on the same network, and the port is right. Try Test again.
"Wrong user name or password"	Re-enter them. For SMB on Windows try `DOMAIN\user` or the PC's name before the user name.
"That server has no shared folder named …"	For SMB use the exact share name, not the computer's name.
A server's key "has changed" (SFTP)	Only continue if you know why (for example you reinstalled the server). Edit the location and re-add it.
Deleted something by accident	Tap **Undo**, or Files home → **Trash** → Restore (within 30 days).

I · Questions and limits

Does the other device need an app?
No. It only needs a web browser.

Is my transfer encrypted?
It is plain Wi-Fi traffic protected by a random token in the link, and optionally a PIN. Anyone who can watch your network traffic could read it, so use a network you trust, or the phone's Hotspot.

Does the app use the internet?
Only for the network locations you add yourself. Transfers stay on your local network.

Can I tap two phones together (NFC)?
No. iPhones don't allow it, so the QR code replaces it.

What if I forget my vault PIN?
The files can't be recovered by anyone. Fingerprint unlock works only while the vault already exists and is a convenience, not a recovery method.

Which Android versions work?
Android 11 or newer.

FileBandit 3.0 · releases and source: github.com/bparkstx/fastshare